17 *A Month with Gokhale* – I

From the very first day of my stay with him Gokhale made me feel completely at home. He treated me as though I were his younger brother, he acquainted himself with all my requirements and arranged to see that I got all I needed. Fortunately my wants were few, and as I had cultivated the habit of self-help, I needed very little personal attendance. He was deeply impressed with my habit of fending for myself, my personal cleanliness, perseverance and regularity, and would often overwhelm me with praise.

He seemed to keep nothing private from me. He would introduce me to all the important people that called on him. Of these the one who stands foremost in memory is Dr (now Sir) P. C. Ray. He lived practically next door and was a very frequent visitor.

This is how he introduced Dr Ray: 'This is Prof. Ray who, having a monthly salary of Rs 800, keeps just Rs 40 for himself and devotes the balance to public purposes. He is not, and does not want to get, married.'

I see little difference between Dr Ray as he is today and as he used to be then. His dress used to be nearly as simple as it is, with this difference of course that whereas it is Khadi now, it used to be Indian mill-cloth in those days. I felt I could never hear too much of the talks between Gokhale and Dr Ray, as they all pertained to public good or were of educative value. At times they were painful too, containing, as they did, strictures on